

A2 Unit 4: Reflections in Literary Studies

***Unit code 6ET04**

- Internally assessed
- Availability: January and June
- First assessment: January 2010

**40%
of the
total A2
marks**

**20% of
the total
GCE
marks**

Content summary:

Poetry, prose or drama for independent study

Free choice of texts

Assessment:

2500-3000 words maximum, including quotations

Either one extended study, or two shorter studies, or a creative response with a commentary

Teacher assessed, internally standardised, externally moderated

B Specification overview

Summary of assessment requirements

Unit number and unit title	Level	Assessment information	Number of marks allocated in the unit
Unit 1: Explorations in Prose and Poetry	AS	External examination: 2 hours 15 minutes Clean copies of the prescribed examination texts must be used in the examination Section A: Unseen poetry or unseen prose, short-answer response Section B: Poetry essay response Section C: Prose essay response	100
Unit 2: Explorations in Drama	AS	Internal assessment 2000-2500 words maximum, including quotations Two responses: explorative study and creative critical response Teacher assessed, internally standardised, externally moderated	80
Unit 3: Interpretations of Prose and Poetry	A2	External examination: 2 hours 45 minutes Clean copies of the prescribed examination texts must be used in the examination Section A: Unprepared prose or poetry Section B: Analytical essay	100
Unit 4: Reflections in Literary Studies	A2	Internal assessment 2500-3000 words maximum, including quotations Either one extended study, or two shorter studies, or a creative response with a commentary Teacher assessed, internally standardised, externally moderated	80

Assessment objectives and weightings

		% in AS	% in A2	% in GCE
AO1	Articulate creative, informed and relevant responses to literary texts, using appropriate terminology and concepts, and coherent, accurate written expression	27.5%	22.5%	25%
AO2	Demonstrate detailed critical understanding in analysing the ways in which structure, form and language shape meanings in literary texts	25%	32.5%	28.75%
AO3	Explore connections and comparisons between different literary texts, informed by interpretations of other readers	32.5%	22.5%	27.5%
AO4	Demonstrate understanding of the significance and influence of the contexts in which literary texts are written and received	15%	22.5%	18.75%

Relationship of assessment objectives to units

Unit number	Assessment objective				
	AO1	AO2	AO3	AO4	Total for AO1, AO2, AO3 and AO4
Unit 1	10%	10%	5%	-	25%
Unit 2	3.75%	2.5%	11.25%	7.5%	25%
Unit 3	5%	10%	5%	5%	25%
Unit 4	6.25%	6.25%	6.25%	6.25%	25%
Total for Advanced GCE	25%	28.75%	27.5%	18.75%	100%

Qualification summary

Subject criteria

The General Certificate of Education is part of the Level 3 provision. This specification is based on the Advanced Subsidiary GCE and Advanced GCE Subject criteria for English Literature; which are prescribed by the regulatory authorities and are mandatory for all awarding bodies.

The Edexcel Advanced Subsidiary and Advanced GCE in English Literature has been designed in accordance with the aims for the subject.

Aims

The aims of the Edexcel Advanced Subsidiary and Advanced GCE in English Literature are to develop students' interest in and enjoyment of literature and literary studies as they:

- read widely and independently set texts and others that they have selected for themselves
- engage creatively with a substantial body of texts and ways of responding to them
- develop and effectively apply their knowledge of literary analysis and evaluation in speech and writing
- explore the contexts of the texts they are reading and others' interpretations of them
- deepen their understanding of the changing traditions of literature in English.

AS/A2 knowledge and understanding

This Advanced Subsidiary and Advanced GCE specification requires students to:

- use their detailed knowledge and understanding of individual works of literature to explore relationships between texts and to appreciate the significance of culture and contextual influences upon readers and writers
- show knowledge and understanding of a range of literary texts and include at least two examples of each of the genres of prose, poetry and drama across the course as a whole
- experience a wide range of reading in poetry, prose and drama that must include at least one play by Shakespeare, work by at least one author writing between 1300 and 1800, at least one work first published or performed after 1990 and, at Advanced Subsidiary, work by at least one author published between 1800 and 1945
- at Advanced Subsidiary, show knowledge and understanding of: the functions and effects of structure, form and language in text; some of the ways in which individual texts are interpreted by different readers; and some of the ways in which texts relate to one another and to the contexts in which they are written and read
- at A2, show knowledge and understanding of the significance of: the ways in which writers use and adapt language, form and structure in texts; the interpretation of texts by different readers, including over time; how texts relate to literary traditions, movements and genres; and the cultural and contextual influence upon readers and writers.

AS/A2 skills

This Advanced Subsidiary and Advanced GCE specification requires students to:

- read texts in a variety of ways and respond critically and creatively
- vary strategies for reading, including for detail, overview and gist, depending on the texts being studied and purposes for reading them
- explore comparisons and contrasts between texts, establishing links and relationships
- identify and consider how attitudes and values are expressed in texts
- draw on their understanding of different interpretations when responding to and evaluating texts
- fluently, accurately and effectively communicate their knowledge, understanding and judgement of texts
- use literary critical concepts and terminology with understanding and discrimination
- make accurate reference to quotations from texts and sources.

In addition, the Advanced GCE specification requires students to show judgement and independence as they:

- synthesise and reflect upon their knowledge and understanding of a range of literary texts and ways of reading them
- make appropriate use of the conventions of writing in literary studies, including quotations and sources.

C English Literature unit content

Course structure	12
------------------	----

Unit 1 Explorations in Prose and Poetry	13
---	----

Unit 2 Explorations in Drama	19
------------------------------	----

Unit 3 Interpretations of Prose and Poetry	29
--	----

Unit 4 Reflections in Literary Studies	35
--	----

Course structure

- Edexcel's GCE in English Literature comprises four units and contains an Advanced Subsidiary subset of two AS units.
- The Advanced Subsidiary GCE is the first half of the GCE course and consists of Units 1 and 2. It may be awarded as a discrete qualification or contribute 50 per cent of the total Advanced GCE marks.
- The full Advanced GCE award consists of the two AS units (Units 1 and 2), plus two A2 units (Units 3 and 4) which make up the other 50 per cent of the Advanced GCE. Students wishing to take the full Advanced GCE must, therefore, complete all four units.
- The structure of this qualification allows teachers to construct a course of study which can be taught and assessed either as:
 - ◆ distinct modules of teaching and learning with related units of assessment taken at appropriate stages during the course; or
 - ◆ a linear course which is assessed in its entirety at the end.